



GRIMES COUNTY BUDGET HEARINGS

OFFICIAL MINUTES — MONDAY, AUGUST 3, 2026

The Grimes County Budget Hearings met on Monday, August 3, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

Call to Order.

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order at 9:02 AM.

Discuss and review the Grimes County FY 2027 proposed budget.

IT Director Gregg Cannon presented the hardware line item for the Information Technology department's budget, the final component of the IT budget not yet brought before the court. Cannon used color-coding to distinguish between new requests marked in red, items requiring detailed discussion highlighted in yellow, and existing budget items in black, with a notation system to identify new requests in the far left corner. The total hardware budget was revised downward from an initially proposed \$1,100,000 to \$743,647 after Cannon re-evaluated the requests. Assistant Auditor Sinda Phelps noted that items in yellow were not included in the total at the top. County Judge Joe Fauth asked for clarification on whether items without an "n" designation were replacements or ongoing expenses, and Cannon explained that blank items indicated line items that were in the previous year's budget. The court reviewed the extensive list line by line, including requests for laptops, software, cameras, servers, and network equipment. Commissioner David Tullos identified a duplication where both a \$2,000 item for five North Barn cameras and a \$1,500 item for four external North Barn cameras appeared on the list, which Cannon acknowledged and removed the duplicate. The discussion covered specialized equipment such as four new camera servers at \$60,000 to address jail and justice center video recording capacity issues, with Cannon explaining that current systems were overloaded and could only retain three months of video in the jail and one month in the justice center, below the six-month compliance standard. A \$191,279 NetApp storage system was discussed as a replacement for aging ArcServe equipment that had reached end of life, with Cannon noting that maintenance on the old system would be discontinued upon approval of the new equipment. Throughout the review, Judge Fauth and commissioners examined the necessity and appropriateness of various items, questioned pricing consistency for similar equipment like monitors and citation printers, and discussed dependencies between IT infrastructure decisions and other court decisions such as potential migration away from the Grimes County Enforcement system to e-Force. Shannon Sanders of the Grimes County Appraisal District was invited to address questions regarding tax rates and revenue implications.

ADJOURN.

A motion to adjourn the meeting was made, seconded, and carried. The meeting adjourned at 12:45 PM.

Motion by Commissioner Michael Raska to Adjourn today's budget meeting. Seconded by

Commissioner Phillip Cox. Carried.

*THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY BUDGET HEARINGS ON August 3rd, 2026, ARE
HEREBY APPROVED.*

Barbara Kimich County Clerk